

●●●● PROTECTION HIGHLIGHTS

Protection of Civilians: According to INSO, the number of security incidents decreased by 20% compared to July. However, the number of civilian casualties increased - OHCHR recorded eleven conflict-related civilian casualties compared to six in July. Nine out of eleven persons suffered from active hostilities, which is comparable to the numbers observed before the ceasefire (27 July 2020). Damages to civilian housing have further increased from 25 cases in July to 36 in August. At least in 12 settlements in GCA electricity supply was interrupted due to shelling, with repairs taking up to 3 weeks. Severe shelling of residential areas and civilian infrastructure took place in Avdiivka, and the railway service has been suspended for one week. The last time the town experienced shelling of such scale was in 2017.

Freedom of movement: Only two out of seven entry-exit crossing points (EECPs) continue to operate. The number of crossings through the EECP 'Stanytsia Luhanska' increased by 12% compared to July reaching more than 85,000 crossings. Since 5 August, the Government [re-established COVID-related requirements](#) and people entering Government-Controlled Area (GCA) through EECPs or international borders are required to install the 'Diya' app, to undergo 10-days self-isolation, or take a COVID-19 test.

IDP housing: On 11 August, the Cabinet of Ministers adopted [Resolution #844](#) providing state subvention for compensation of the purchase of housing for IDPs, who are veterans and civilians with disability incurred due to hostilities. On 31 August, the second group of 150 IDPs who will benefit from the preferential long-term mortgage loans (KfW) was selected. So far, 300 IDPs were selected. It is expected that in 2021-2022, 680 households or 1,768 IDPs will benefit from this programme.

Legal developments: On 18 August, the Government adopted the [Strategy](#) 'On economic development of Donetsk and Luhansk regions until 2030'. The document provides for the improvement of the economical situation in the region; support of small and medium enterprises; stimulating investments; development of local infrastructure, including transportation, railways, electricity supply, internet coverage; demining of agricultural lands; empowerment of local communities.

Access to pensions: On 26 August, Oschchadbank prolonged the validity of the cards expired during quarantine restrictions until 1 October. This will allow the residents of NGCA to continue withdrawing their pensions and social payments without undergoing physical identification and re-issuing the new bank card.

Decentralization: After 9 months since the beginning of the process, all 18 Heads of Civil-Military Administrations (CMAs) are appointed. The appointments provide more clarity in leadership at local level and ability to initiate process to establish all expected social and administrative services. According to the [monitoring](#) conducted by the Protection Cluster in 27 conflict-affected communities along the contact line (18 CMAs and 9 Amalgamated Territorial Communities (ATCs), there is some progress observed since July: a) TSNAPs are officially established or have mobile coverage in 24 out of the 27 monitored communities; b) Centers for provision of social services are established in 21 of the monitored communities; c) Services for child affairs were established in 26 of the monitored communities. The availability of specialized protection services varies according to different locations, with partners reporting gaps in specific services, shortages of staff and/or lack of training of local service providers. Access to services for people residing in isolated settlements still remains a concern. This situation is temporarily addressed by UHF-funded projects on social transportation launched by two protection partners in July 2021. Seven protection partners launched projects in 23 communities (15 CMAs and 8 ATCs) to support authorities and the local population during the decentralization process through capacity building activities, community mobilization, and technical assistance.

PROTECTION CLUSTER CONTACTS

Raquel Trabazo, Protection Cluster Coordinator, trabazo@unhcr.org

Kateryna Martynenko, Child Protection Sub-Cluster Coordinator kmartynenko@unicef.org

Olena Kochemyrovskaya, GBV Sub-Cluster Coordinator kochemyrovskaya@unfpa.org

Martin Oubrecht, Mine Action Sub-Cluster Coordinator martin.oubrecht@undp.org

Akbar Nazriev Age and Disability TWG Coordinator akbar.nazriev@helpage.org

Volodymyr Khorbaladze, Housing, Land and Property TWG Coordinator volodymyr.khorbaladze@nrc.no

ONLINE DASHBOARDS/MAPS

[Protection Cluster 5W 2021](#)

[Protection Cluster partners' operational presence – March 2021](#)

[Explosive Ordnance Risk Education \(EORE\) Sessions](#)

[MHPSS and GBV Services](#)

[Checkpoints: people's monthly crossings](#)

[Settlements Map](#)

[Legal Aid Directory](#)

●●●● OPERATIONAL RESPONSE

- **Protection and legal counseling:** NGO 'Right to Protection' (R2P), in partnership with UNHCR, provided 646 legal consultations. R2P/UNHCR monitors at EECPS and IBCPs supported 1,401 persons to install 'Diya' mobile application. Norwegian Refugee Council (NRC) provided information, counselling, and legal assistance to 545 persons. NRC's community-based network of paralegals provided 221 individual counselling in the settlements along the contact line. NGO Donbas SOS provided individual counselling and legal assistance to 1,362 persons through its hotline - 28% of inquiries related to crossing procedures, 24% - access to documentation, and 16% - access to pensions.



- **Individual Protection Assistance:** UNHCR provided individual protection assistance to 18 vulnerable IDPs households, consisting of 44 persons, who suffered from COVID-19 across Ukraine. UNHCR provided in-kind assistance for 180 persons, residing in Luhansk NGCA.
- **Mine action:** The HALO Trust cleared 8 hectares of mine-contaminated land and conducted online and offline Explosive Ordnance Risk Education (EORE) sessions for 11,041 children, teachers, and caregivers. On 8-18 August, Terre des Hommes jointly with UNICEF organized a summer camp for 20 children suffered from mines/ERW and provided psychosocial support (PSS). Polish Humanitarian Action jointly with UNICEF launched a project in Donetsk region to provide PSS for children and caregivers suffered from mines/ERW. The project will include case management, sessions on positive parenting, capacity building for education specialists on inclusivity, PSS.
- **Older people:** HelpAge International provided home-based care and psychosocial support to 2,500 older people in 13 settlements along the contact line in Donetsk region. Polish Humanitarian Action provided home-based care to 571 older people residing in 30 settlements in Donetsk region.
- **Vaccination – Community Awareness:** The Protection Cluster's TWG on Age and Disability (led by HelpAge) is hosting training sessions to protection field workers on provision of reliable information on the importance of vaccination, to allow affected population to take an informed decision. UNICEF and Ukrainian Catholic University are facilitating the sessions. In August-September, 248 social workers and field staff were trained and already held information sessions to more than 5,100 persons living close to the contact line, mostly older people.
- **IDPs:** UNHCR held a Participatory Assessment with IDPs in Luhansk and Donetsk. Key findings and gaps remain unchanged: lack of durable housing solutions, livelihoods/employment, difficulties and bureaucratic hurdles in accessing the state and financial services, acquisition of various civil documents due to the IDP registration.
- **Capacity building:** People in Need conducted four trainings on 'Minimum Standards for Child Protection in Humanitarian Action', 'Improving PSS through Grant Support', 'Community Mobilization', and 'Basics of Emotional Literacy' for 65 persons participating in the implementation of small-grants projects funded by PIN. SOS Children's Villages within the project on economical sustainability for vulnerable families, conducted trainings and coaching sessions, job re-training, and provision of funding for equipment for 73 persons.
- **Transportation services:** NGO 'Proliska' supported by UNHCR, provided transportation services to 9,029 persons with limited mobility on the GCA side of the ECCP 'Stanytsia Luhanska'.



ADVOCACY

- NRC presented the [report 'Housing for IDPs in Ukraine: steps towards durable solutions'](#), which provides an analysis of existing national and regional housing solutions for IDPs. The event gathered almost 100 representatives of the key profile ministries, regional state administrations, local authorities, and NGOs.
- Stabilization Support Services jointly with People in Need released a [research](#) 'Life on the Line: Decentralization and access to services in Donetsk and Luhansk regions GCA'

describing the impact of decentralization on access to services and recommendations to national, regional and local authorities. The results are expected to be presented before state bodies of all levels.